

Chapter 32 — Qal–Piel–Pual Contrast Drill (Strong Roots)

BBH Chapter 32 · Pual Strong Verbs

Each triplet shows the same root in Qal, Piel, and Pual (Perfect 3ms). For each form: (1) identify the stem, (2) parse fully, (3) translate. Focus on the R1 vowel: variable (Qal), hiriq/tsere (Piel), qibbuts/holes (Pual). Answer key is on the last page.

Stem contrast (Perfect 3ms): Qal = qamets or tsere under R1, no dagesh in R2. Piel = hiriq or tsere under R1 + dagesh forte in R2. Pual = qibbuts under R1 + dagesh forte in R2 (holes when R2 is guttural and rejects dagesh).

Triplet 1 — Root: brk (bless)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
1	בִּרַךְ				
2	בִּרַךְ				
3	בִּרַךְ				

Triplet 2 — Root: shlkh (send)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
4	שָׁלַח				
5	שָׁלַח				
6	שָׁלַח				

Triplet 3 — Root: dbr (speak)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
7	דָּבַר				
8	דָּבַר				
9	דָּבַר				

Triplet 4 — Root: kbd (honor)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
10	כָּבַד				
11	כָּבַד				
12	כָּבַד				

Triplet 5 — Root: spr (count / tell)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
13	סָפַר				
14	סָפַר				
15	סָפַר				

Reflection Questions

- Across all five triplets, the R1 vowel follows a pattern: gamets or tsere (Qal), hiriq or tsere (Piel), qibbutz (Pual). Write this as a three-step diagnostic rule.
- Root brk (triplets 1, 3): the resh (r) rejects dagesh forte in R2. How does this affect the Piel vowel (tsere under b instead of hiriq)? And the Pual vowel (holem instead of qibbutz)?
- Root kbd (triplet 4): the Qal is stative (he was heavy). What does the Piel add to make it factitive? What grammatical role does the human recipient play in Piel vs. Pual?

Answer Key**Triplet 1 — Root: brk (bless)**

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
1	בָּרַךְ				
✓	בָּרַךְ	Qal	Perfect	3ms	he knelt
2	בָּרַךְ				
✓	בָּרַךְ	Piel	Perfect	3ms	he blessed
3	בִּרְךָ				
✓	בִּרְךָ	Pual	Perfect	3ms	he was blessed

Triplet 2 — Root: shlkh (send)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
4	שָׁלַח				
✓	שָׁלַח	Qal	Perfect	3ms	he sent
5	שָׁלַח				
✓	שָׁלַח	Piel	Perfect	3ms	he sent away / released
6	שָׁלַח				
✓	שָׁלַח	Pual	Perfect	3ms	he was sent away

Triplet 3 — Root: dbr (speak)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
7	דָּבַר				
✓	דָּבַר	Qal	Perfect	3ms	he spoke (rare)
8	דָּבַר				
✓	דָּבַר	Piel	Perfect	3ms	he spoke
9	דָּבַר				
✓	דָּבַר	Pual	Perfect	3ms	it was spoken

Triplet 4 — Root: kbd (honor)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
10	קָבַד				
✓	קָבַד	Qal	Perfect	3ms	he was heavy / honored (stative)
11	קָבַד				
✓	קָבַד	Piel	Perfect	3ms	he honored
12	קָבַד				
✓	קָבַד	Pual	Perfect	3ms	he was honored

Triplet 5 — Root: spr (count / tell)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
13	סָפַר				
✓	סָפַר	Qal	Perfect	3ms	he counted
14	סָפַר				
✓	סָפַר	Piel	Perfect	3ms	he recounted / told
15	סָפַר				
✓	סָפַר	Pual	Perfect	3ms	it was told / recounted